THE LOOKING GLASS BEAUTY SCHOOL

A03 Theory Mark Scheme

For tutor and assessor use. Not to be given to learners before the assessment.

Liquid and Powder Acrylic Enhancement CPD Course | Course author: Jessica Jane Preston | Version 1.3, November 2026

Section 1: multiple choice, 1 mark each

Q	Answer	Correct option
1	b	Monomer, normally ethyl methacrylate (EMA), with a catalyst
2	b	The liquid wetting the powder and releasing the initiator
3	c	Too wet
4	a	Wet beads and product on the skin
5	b	A warmer room and a larger bead
6	b	Not listed as prohibited, but unsafe for nail use; some licensing authorities prohibit it by name
7	b	It will not soak off in acetone in a reasonable time
8	c	In the back third of the finished nail, supporting the stress area
9	b	Shape: a correctly placed apex, even C-curve and straight sidewalls
10	b	The stress area and the apex
11	d	240 grit
12	b	Shaping and reducing set product only
13	b	An extractor at the point of filing that draws dust away from both faces
14	b	Not respiratory protection
15	b	Lidded whenever you are not drawing from it
16	b	Fitted sidewall to sidewall with its C-curve matched to the natural nail
17	b	Lets product reach living tissue and traps moisture
18	b	Correct technique
19	b	Moves the apex forward each visit until the nail breaks at the stress area
20	b	Traps moisture and bacteria and is never done
21	b	20 to 30 minutes
22	b	Reduce the bulk with a hand file, leaving a thin layer
23	b	Bacterial colonisation, commonly Pseudomonas, in a moist space
24	b	A swollen, red, tender nail fold with pus present
25	b	Sparingly, to the plate only, as the manufacturer directs
26	b	Assess the risk from the actual products and tasks, using their Safety Data Sheets
27	b	'Designed to last between infills; wear varies with nail condition, lifestyle and aftercare'
28	b	Not taught or assessed; it needs separate, specific training

Section 2: short answer, 2 marks each

29. Describe a correct bead, and say what a wet bead does to the client.

- Holds a soft dome on the brush, settles gently when pressed and can be guided into place (1)
- A wet bead floods the folds and leaves free monomer on the skin: the main route to sensitisation, and it lifts (1)

30. Name the four things a balanced nail needs.

- Apex in the back third; a supported stress area; an even C-curve; straight sidewalls meeting the natural sidewall without a step or gap (2 for four, 1 for two or three)

31. Give three things that change the set time of a bead.

- Any three of: the product system, room temperature, mix ratio, bead size, contamination on the plate (2 for three, 1 for two)

32. Why is a hairline gap at the cuticle area correct technique, and what does product on the skin lead to?

- Product that touches living tissue lifts there within days and the gap grows out invisibly (1)
- Product on skin is repeated exposure to unreacted monomer: irritation and, over time, permanent sensitisation (1)

33. Explain the difference between an infill and a rebalance, and why every maintenance appointment does both.

- An infill fills the regrowth; a rebalance reduces the old apex and rebuilds it in the back third as the nail grows forward (1)
- Filling without rebalancing moves the apex forward a little each visit; after a few cycles the nail breaks at the stress area (1)

34. Name three warning signs of an MMA-type product and state what you do about it.

- Any three of: a strong or unusual smell unlike your usual monomer; product that will not soak off in a reasonable time; enhancements so hard they shatter and take plate with them; unusually cheap, unlabelled or no Safety Data Sheet (1)
- Stop using it, obtain the SDS and check the named monomer; do not drill it off the natural nail; do not buy from a supplier who cannot provide an SDS (1)

35. Name the two exposures specific to acrylic work and one control for each.

- Filing dust: source-capture extraction at the point of filing, damp-wiping, no desk fan (1)
- Monomer vapour: dappen dish lidded, bottles capped, only the amount needed decanted, wipes in a lidded bin, general ventilation as well (1)

36. Before you take health information at the consultation, what must the client be given or told under data protection law?

- A privacy notice: who holds the data, why, the lawful basis, how long it is kept and her rights (1)
- That health data is sensitive and only what is needed for safe treatment is asked; photograph consent is separate and optional (1)

Section 3: scenarios, 3 marks each (one mark per point, any order; equivalent wording accepted)

37. Scenario A. A regular client arrives with three nails lifted at the cuticle area and one with a crack through the stress area. She has a wedding in four days. Set out your assessment, what you do to each nail, what you say about the crack, and what you record.

- Assesses every nail and the skin before touching a file; removes lifted product entirely from the three nails, never fills over it; re-prepares the exposed plate and rebuilds with the apex repositioned (1)
- The cracked nail: product removed back to sound material and the nail rebuilt; explains that a patched structural crack will fail again, so a patch for the wedding is not offered (1)
- Checks for moisture or discolouration under the lifted areas and acts on it; looks for the cause (preparation, apex position, length against her work); records findings, products and advice, and books the next infill (1)

38. Scenario B. Midway through a set you notice the beads are spreading and flooding the sidewalls, and the room is warmer than usual. Explain what is happening, what you change, and why leaving it would matter beyond appearance.

- Recognises the ratio has drifted wet; wipes more liquid from the brush on the lip of the dish, picks up smaller beads and commits to placement, since the warm room shortens working time (1)
- Removes any product that has reached the folds or sidewalls with the brush now, before it sets, rather than filing it off later (1)
- Explains that wet product on skin is free monomer: the route to sensitisation for the client and the professional, and the cause of lifting; adjusts the room or extraction, keeps the dish lidded, and records what was changed (1)

Marking rules

- Total 50. Pass mark 40 (80%). Partial credit applies in Sections 2 and 3 as shown; no partial credit in Section 1.
- Equivalent wording is accepted throughout. Spelling and grammar are not marked; a reasonable adjustment that records oral answers is marked on content alone.
- Safety-critical errors: an answer anywhere on the paper that instructs using MMA or an unlabelled product, applying product onto living tissue, working with a wet bead, filing without extraction, prising or drilling an enhancement off, electric-file work on the natural nail, or concealing infection is discussed with the learner and corrected before a pass is recorded, whatever the score. Record the correction on the front sheet.
- A learner who scores below 40 may re-sit the paper once, after a minimum of seven days' further study. The re-sit uses this paper; the tutor questions the learner orally on any item answered the same way twice.
- Keep the marked paper in the learner's portfolio with the practical marking sheet (A04) and the case-study log (manual Form D).